

PURPOSE: To allow seniors to decorate their mortarboard for graduation.

INTRODUCED BY: Sabrina Sims

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

MSMS currently does not allow seniors to decorate their graduation caps to keep everyone equal and eliminate competition, the same reasoning for no valedictorian or cords. However, decorating graduation caps is different than cords, it is an expression of creativity, a core ideal of MSMS. To eliminate this opportunity would be to go against this ideal. At graduation the class is to be “one” but within this “one” we are many and this opportunity would allow the expression of this many while still being together as “one.”

SECTION TWO (APPENDIX):

Possible Guidelines for Decorating:

1. Decoration may not extend more than an inch from the cap.
2. Decoration may not include any political content.
3. Decoration may not contain any harmful or inappropriate language.
4. Decoration may not include any ~~activities~~/accomplishments.
5. **Decoration may not include any flags.**
6. Decoration should not make noise.
7. Decoration should not hang from the mortarboard.
8. Decoration may include intended college or military path.
9. Decoration may include jewels.
10. Decoration may include floral arrangements within the height limit.

Other Schools Guidelines:

<https://phs.wjUSD.org/Students/Senior-Page/Graduation-Cap-Decorating-Guidelines/>

https://www.salisbury.edu/administration/academic-affairs/commencement/files/Graduation_Decoration_Guidelines.pdf

<https://196949.fs1.hubspotusercontent-na1.net/hubfs/196949/Documents/Admissions/Graduation/Mortar%20Board%20Graduation%20Decoration%20Parameters.pdf>

SECTION THREE (RESPONSES):

Response 1 (Iysiahs York):

“Since I'm a part of the really small group of people that get to decorate the caps, I would appreciate it if others got to decorate theirs as well. I feel there might be some mixed opinions from certain families on only letting the Natives decorate their caps.”

Response 2 (Anonymous):

“I understand the idea that we aren't competing against each other academically so we aren't allowed cords or medals, but decorating a cap isn't gloating or anything so I think we can break with the uniformity a little and allow everyone the ability to express themselves because ultimately it's the students' graduation, not the school's.”

Response 3 (Anonymous):

“Throughout my high school career, I've seen so many pictures of people decorating their caps together and walking across the stage with them. It has always been something I've looked forward to. Upon finding out that we weren't allowed to here, I was deeply disappointed, especially because MSMS is supposed to embrace creativity.”

Response 4 (Anonymous):

“MSMS is a school that fosters a love for culture and teaches us to be proud of who we are. We should be able to represent ourselves on arguably the most important day of our high school career.”

Response 5 (Anonymous):

“I think it's important for graduation to look classy and cohesive. It would be very hard to ensure that people have appropriate designs on their caps, and there would be at least one person who takes advantage of that. I believe it isn't inhibiting creativity because it's only for a few hours. Sure, it's an important day, but, like you said, you could just decorate a separate cap. Maybe another option would be for MSMS to allow part of the ceremony (maybe the tossing?) to use the decorated caps and another part (walking?) to use the classic, matching ones.”

Response 6 (Anonymous):

“Being able to decorate our caps shows the unique side of every student. Not only does the gown unite us with our school, but it should also show our personality.”

Response 7 (Anonymous):

“We have spent at least two years worrying about professionalism. Graduation should be the day where we can show off how creative we are and what is really important to us.”